

Password and Credential Management Standard

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The management of passwords and credentials is a critical aspect of maintaining the security and integrity of our systems, data, and overall organizational reputation. As outlined in our Data Classification and Handling Policy, sensitive information, including customer data, requires robust protection measures to prevent unauthorized access. In line with this policy, all systems holding customer data must implement multi-factor authentication (MFA) as a mandatory requirement for user login credentials.

When it comes to password management, employees are expected to adhere to the following guidelines: passwords must be at least 14 characters in length and rotated every 180 days. This ensures that even if an employee's password is compromised, the attacker will not have access to their account for an extended period. Furthermore, as described under our Conflict of Interest Disclosure Policy, employees are expected to disclose any potential conflicts of interest that may impact their ability to manage sensitive information securely.

In addition to these guidelines, all employees must use a secure and unique password for each system they access. Passwords should be stored in a secure location, such as a password manager, and not shared with colleagues or third-party vendors. Employees are also responsible for reporting any security incidents or breaches related to their account activity to the IT department immediately.

The IT department is responsible for implementing and enforcing these password management policies across all systems, including but not limited to email, file sharing, and database access. Regular audits will be conducted to ensure compliance with these guidelines, and employees who fail to adhere to these standards may face disciplinary action.